

emulators, it's a piece of software that apes a mobile device, mobile browser or mobile OS on a desktop platform (more on this later in the chapter). Let's talk about the purposes for which mobile emulators are used.

Testing and debugging apps

Mobile apps are becoming increasingly powerful by the day, some are even being used to control cars (James Bond, anyone?) and drones. With the immense number of mobile phones being released in the market, it's simply not possible and feasible for app developers to buy each and every device available in the market. In such a scenario, mobile emulators come to the rescue, as they emulate the software environment of a mobile phone on a desktop, thus allowing developers to install apps on these emulators and test them.

Testing and debugging websites

Reports from around the world indicate that more people are browsing and working online from their mobile phones than ever before, and this trend is only set to increase. You may have noticed that your favourite website differs in looks and functionality – be it the layout, adjustments in size or operation of the website – depending on the device or browser on which it's being accessed. This is because developers create a separate version of the website for access on mobile devices. For this, they need to test the website code on mobile browsers; again it isn't feasible to test the website on different browsers installed on devices with different display sizes. Mobile emulators enable developers to test their websites on different emulated devices with different screen sizes.

Running apps and games

Earlier, the term 'emulators' was only known to developers and uber geeks, but now this scene is changing as emulators are going beyond their role of simply being software used for testing and debugging apps and websites. Emulators are now being increasingly used to display mobile apps and games on a bigger screen (*Candy Crush* fans, this one is for you). Imagine playing *Hungry Shark* or using your favourite app on a much bigger screen. This is especially convenient if you frequently use apps.

People who own Windows tablets can now stop complaining about the lack of apps for the platform and get the Android experience on their devices.